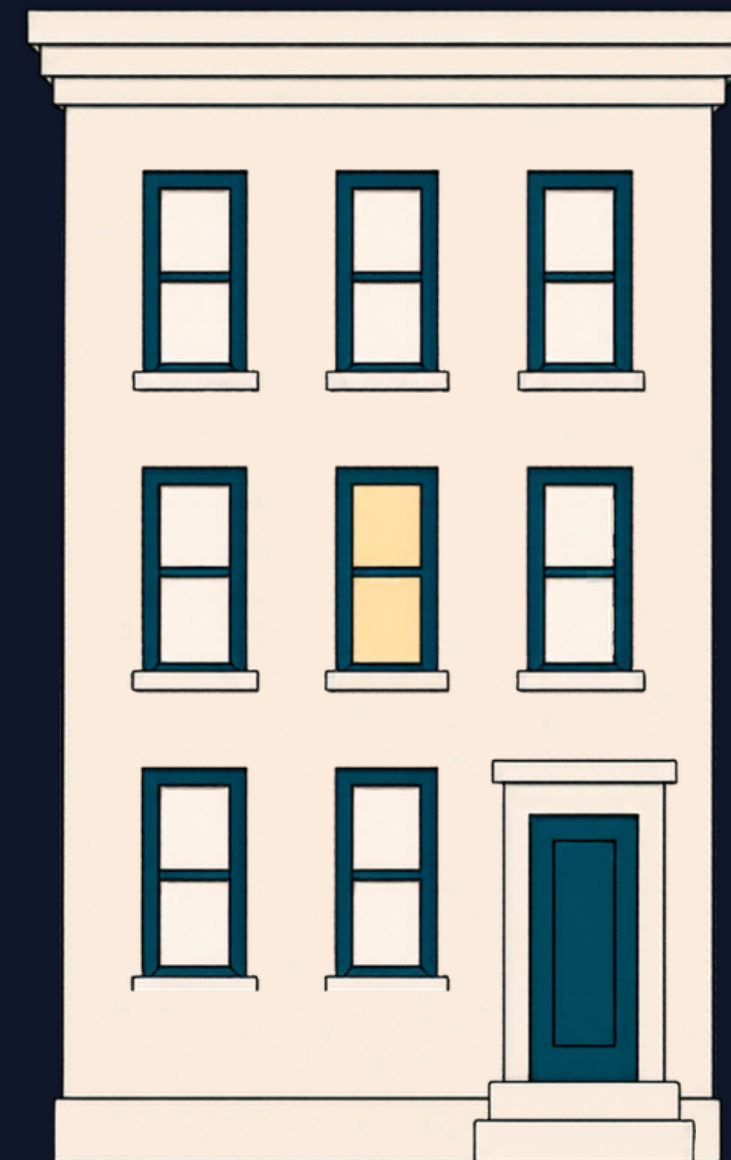


RateMyPlace

Know before you sign.



Yale Innovation Summit 2026 · Tech Track

Meredith McGee, MPH

NEW HAVEN, CONNECTICUT · 2023-2025



I thought my first apartment in grad school would be where I wrote my thesis.

Instead, it was where I:

- filed 15 maintenance requests
- lived without a working shower
- woke up to a stranger bent over my bathtub

In the end, I broke my lease and was forced out of New Haven.

This isn't just my story.

37%

renters say they would sign a lease without ever seeing the apartment in person.

Source:
Apartments.com, 2024

1 in 3

renters have had a landlord enter their home without permission.

Source:
LendingTree National Renter Survey, 2024

3.9
Million

renter households live in inadequate housing.

Source:
HUD American Housing Survey, 2021

Renters can't afford to be picky. They can't get honest answers. And they have nowhere to check.



We read reviews before booking a hotel.

We check safety ratings before buying a car.

We scroll Yelp for a restaurant we won't remember in a week.

But the place where you sleep, cook, shower, and live for the next year?

Landlords check your credit, criminal history, income, and references.

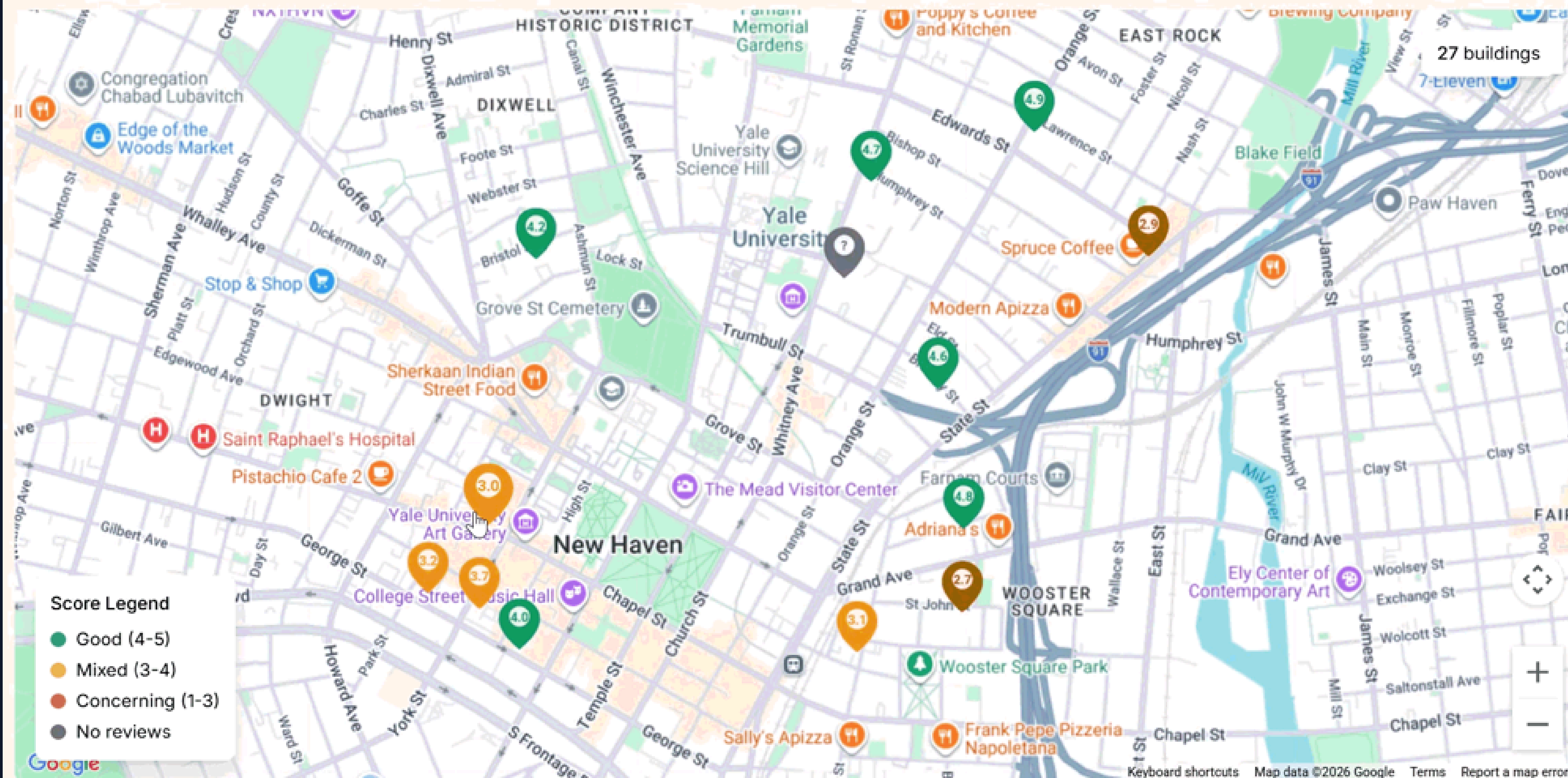
Renters get a 20-minute showing.



You go in blind.



Browse apartments on the map. Colors indicate tenant review scores.





RateMyPlace

Know Before You Sign.

old building, but below average rent

★★★★★ 4.7 overall

Unit: 4.4 Building: 5.0 Landlord: 5.0

2 bedrooms

SUMMER 2025 - 2026

Within the last year

\$1,750/mo

kinda hate that im moving out of this place because 1. its relatively cheap 2. in a great area 3. a decent landlord this building is old and that's evident. kitchen is incredibly tiny galley kitchen with a smaller than average stove/oven and refrigerator. heat is included in rent, and it gets TOASTY in the winter. The rent was only increased by \$75 on the renewal. The building is quiet and mostly Yale grad students. There is ongoing construction across the street that does tend to go late until 11 pm some nights and is constant all day, very noisy if you WFH. building does have mice problems, but you can get a cat to fix that!

2 beds 1 bath 800 sq ft

UNIT CONDITION 4.4	BUILDING 5.0	LANDLORD 5.0
Structure *	4/5	Common areas 5/5
Plumbing *	5/5	Security * 5/5
Electrical	5/5	Exterior 5/5
Climate control *	5/5	Neighbor noise 5/5
Ventilation	4/5	External noise 5/5
Pest control *	3/5	Mail and packages 5/5
Mold and moisture *	4/5	Laundry 5/5
Appliances	5/5	Parking Not rated
Layout	5/5	Trash 5/5
As advertised	5/5	

* Health and safety weighted. These factors count more in the overall score. [Learn more](#)

UTILITIES INCLUDED

Heat Hot water Water Trash

AMENITIES

Storage Elevator Pet friendly

Laundry: Coin-Op (\$2/load) Parking: Available (Extra)

Pets allowed: Dogs Small Animals Cats

Section 8: Accepted Well lit at night

Would recommend Email verified

Not the worst ever, but DEFINITELY not worth if you can avoid it

2 bedrooms

★★★★★ 3.6 overall

FALL 2025 - CURRENT

Current tenant

\$2,600/mo

Unit: 3.9 Building: 3.5 Landlord: 3.3

Within the first few months of living here, we experienced around 4-5 different ceiling water leaks. Our carbon monoxide detector was expired since before we moved in and it took them around 2-3 months (of us constantly messaging them) to get them to replace it. Half of the laundry machines are broken, the other half leave your clothes wet. Main maintenance people have walked in on others without announcing. I've heard them reach for their keys as they try to open our door, even though I always specify in my maintenance requests to not enter if I'm not there. Like are there worse places to live in? Yeah, technically. But this place still sucks.

2 beds 1 bath

UNIT CONDITION 3.9	BUILDING 3.5	LANDLORD 3.3
Structure *	2/5	Common areas 4/5
Plumbing *	5/5	Security * 3/5
Electrical	5/5	Exterior 5/5
Climate control *	3/5	Neighbor noise 2/5
Ventilation	4/5	External noise 5/5
Pest control *	4/5	Mail and packages 3/5
Mold and moisture *	5/5	Laundry 1/5
Appliances	4/5	Parking Not rated
Layout	3/5	Trash 5/5
As advertised	4/5	

* Health and safety weighted. These factors count more in the overall score. [Learn more](#)

UTILITIES INCLUDED

Hot water Gas

AMENITIES

Dishwasher Pet friendly

Laundry: Coin-Op (\$4/load) Parking: Street only

Pets allowed: Cats Dogs

Issues reported: Plumbing issues

Section 8: Unsure Well lit at night

Would recommend Email verified

Not Yelp for apartments.

Mold *doesn't* score the same as a noisy radiator.

Our 27-item assessment is built from three validated public health instruments

- OHQS for unit-level conditions
- PHQS for building quality
- WHO LARES for landlord behavior

Each item is weighted by what it actually does to your body. Mold, pests, lead, and unauthorized entry weigh more than scuffed paint or a dated kitchen.

WHY SOME ITEMS COUNT MORE

Health and safety weighting

Some housing conditions have stronger associations with health outcomes than others. The weights below come from epidemiological research:

1.5x Weight Pest control

Pest infestations (cockroaches, rodents, bed bugs) are strongly associated with asthma, allergic reactions, and disease transmission. Cockroach allergen is a major trigger for childhood asthma in urban environments.

Reference: Krieger & Higgins (2002), American Journal of Public Health

1.5x Weight Mold and moisture

Visible mold and dampness are associated with a 1.5-3.5x increased odds ratio for respiratory symptoms, including asthma, wheeze, and upper respiratory infections. This is one of the most well-documented housing-health relationships.

Reference: Jacobs et al. (2009), Environmental Health Perspectives

1.3x Weight Structural integrity

Structural deficiencies including damaged floors, walls, and ceilings pose direct injury risks from falls, collapses, and accidents. Poor structural condition also often indicates deferred maintenance affecting other systems.

Reference: Bonnefoy et al. (2003), WHO LARES Study



Meredith McGee, MPH

Yale School of Public Health
Social and Behavioral Sciences

I lived the problem in New Haven.
I have the training to help fix it.

I built this website between two jobs, on nights
and weekends because I believe no renter
should have to go through what I went through.

1 BUILDER

\$0 EXTERNAL
INVESTMENT

30+ REVIEWS

WHAT'S NEXT



SCALE

Boston + New Haven,
then the Northeast.

Intros to tenant orgs,
reporters, and renters
welcome!

PARTNERSHIPS

Tenant unions. Legal
aid. Public health.

CT Tenants Union, GBTU,
MA DPH, Local alders and
elected officials.

FUNDING

The capacity to
work on this.

Grants, fellowships,
partnerships.
Pointers welcome!

I built RateMyPlace so the next tenant won't have to document their apartment the way I did.

CONTACT

meredith@ratemyplace.org



SITE & METHODOLOGY

ratemyplace.org